

vision**2**learn

Understanding Autism

Hints
and
Tips

Unit 4



Contents

Session 1 – Understand how individuals with autism process sensory information	4
Session 2 – Know how to recognise and support sensory needs	6
Session 3 – Understand the cognitive differences individuals with autism may have in processing information	8

Hints and Tips Unit 4

The information in this guide will be helpful to you when you are ready to complete your assessment for the following unit:

Unit 4 - Sensory processing, perception and cognition in individuals with autism

Session 1 – Understand how individuals with autism process sensory information

Q1. In the box below, **outline** how differences in processing sensory information may affect each of the **senses** [1.1]

This is quite a straightforward question as all the information required is in the reveals in page 2 of the course materials. You just need to ensure that your answer is in your own words and not copied directly from the course content.

Q2. In the table below, **define** what is meant by:

- hypersensitivity
- hyposensitivity [1.2]

This question is simply asking for a definition of the two terms. the information is included in the slides on page 2 just ensure that you don't copy the information directly from the course materials.

Q3. In the box below, **outline** why individuals with autism may experience balance difficulties (vestibular sense). [1.3]

For this question you need to give an outline of the difficulties that they may experience. As well as using the course materials to help you with your answer you may also find the following website helpful.

[Balance and Vestibular Systems \(thesoundlearningcentre.co.uk\)](https://thesoundlearningcentre.co.uk)

Q4. In the box below, **explain** how individuals with autism may experience difficulties with body awareness (proprioception). [1.4]

This is an explain question so you need to provide good detail in your response. Along with the information in the course materials the following website may be helpful when formulating your answer.

[Proprioception and autism \(autismtogether.co.uk\)](https://autismtogether.co.uk/proprioception-and-autism/)

Q5. In the box below, give **examples** of behaviours that may suggest an individual is hyposensitive or hypersensitive. [1.5]

For this question you need to give at least 3 examples. The following website has quite a lot of additional information that you may find useful when formulating your answer.

[Sensory Hyper- and Hyposensitivity in Autism - Integrated Treatment Services](#)

Session 2 – Know how to recognise and support sensory needs

Q1. In the table below, **identify** examples of the type of environments and situations that might contribute to an individual experiencing sensory overload. [2.1]

This question is quite straightforward as it is simply asking for you to identify so you can just list your responses.

Q2. In the table below, give **examples** of how individuals with autism may respond when experiencing **sensory overload**. [2.2]

For this question you need to use the information on page 1 of session 2 to help you formulate your answer. Make sure that you answer this in your own words as it can be tempting to copy directly from the course material. Try to give as much detail as possible in your examples.

Q3. In the table below, **outline** strategies that can be used to support individuals experiencing sensory overload. [2.3]

For this question think about what you can do to support individuals experiencing sensory overload. What can you do? What can you put in place that will minimise the impact of sensory overload?

Q4. In the box below, **describe** how to create a 'low arousal' sensory environment. [2.4]

This is a describe question so make sure that you provide good detail in your answer. As well as the content in the course material the following website has some useful information that will help when formulating your answer.

[The Low Arousal Approach at Home - Autism Awareness \(autismawarenesscentre.com\)](https://autismawarenesscentre.com/The-Low-Arousal-Approach-at-Home)

Q5. In the table below, give **examples** of ways to increase sensory stimulation. [2.5]

This question is quite straightforward and all of the information you require is on page 2 all you have to do is give examples in your own words of the different ways that you can increase sensory information. You may also want to carry out some additional research to help you formulate your responses.

Q6. In the box below, **describe** the benefits of sensory activities for individuals with autism [2.6]

This is a describe question so make sure you provide good detail in your answer. Think about the different benefits that sensory activities can have for individuals. You may find the following website useful for additional research when formulating your answer.

[5 Benefits of Sensory Activities for Individuals with Autism \(softsurfaces.co.uk\)](https://softsurfaces.co.uk/5-Benefits-of-Sensory-Activities-for-Individuals-with-Autism)

Q7. In the box below, **outline** how sensory differences may have an influence on an individual's dietary preferences. [2.7]

For this question you need to think about individuals with autism can have their dietary preferences influenced by sensory differences. As well as the course materials the following website has some information that will assist you in developing your response.

[May17-Food-Challenges-Help-Sheet-Issue-9-050917.pdf \(optionsautism.co.uk\)](https://optionsautism.co.uk/May17-Food-Challenges-Help-Sheet-Issue-9-050917.pdf)

Q8. In the box below, **explain** how to support the dietary preferences of individuals with autism. [2.8]

This is an explain question so you need to provide good detail in your answer. Think about the different ways that dietary preferences can be supported. Try to cover both undersensitivity and oversensitivity in your response as well as the different people who can help. The following website has some useful information that will assist you when formulating your answer.

[May17-Food-Challenges-Help-Sheet-Issue-9-050917.pdf \(optionsautism.co.uk\)](https://optionsautism.co.uk/May17-Food-Challenges-Help-Sheet-Issue-9-050917.pdf)

Session 3 – Understand the cognitive differences individuals with autism may have in processing information

Q1. In the table below, **outline** the difficulties an individual with autism may have with:

- processing information
- predicting the consequences of an action
- organising, prioritising and sequencing
- understanding the concept of time. [3.1]

For this question make sure that you cover all four points in good detail to demonstrate your understanding. There is quite a lot of information on page 1 of session 3 relating to this so take the time to digest this fully before answering this question.

Q2. In the box below, **describe strategies** that could be used to support an individual with autism to complete activities/tasks. [3.2]

There are a number of strategies mentioned on page 2 of session 3 to help you with this and you may also want to carry out additional research to assist you when formulating your answer.

[all audiences \(autism.org.uk\)](https://www.autism.org.uk)